

9.2 Assessment information

This unit is assessed by means of a written examination paper of 1 hour 30 minutes' duration. Students may be required to apply their knowledge and understanding of biology to situations that they have not seen before.

The total number of marks available for this examination paper is 40. It contributes 10 per cent to the International Advanced Level in Biology.

Students must have a calculator for this paper.

The examination will consist of two questions.

The first question will be based on an area of one (or more) of the specified core practicals, but will generally be set in a novel situation. Students will be expected to apply familiar core practical techniques to answer this question successfully. The number of marks for this question will be 20.

The second questions will be based on a partially complete visit/issue report that will be provided. Students will be required to comment on material already in the report and to suggest improvements or/and additions. Ten minutes reading time is built in.

The overall aim is to assess a student's ability to understand how to produce such a report as described in the criteria on page 76 of the specification. The number of marks for this question will be 20.